

Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Online payment fraud is a cybercrime where an criminal tricks an innocent person into sending money via digital payment platforms like UPI or online banking. Online payment scams usually involve tricks of deception and false payment notifications to take money from their victims.

A general case of online payment fraud starts with a phone call, social media message, or online platform notification from a fraudster to an innocent victim. First of all, a cybercriminal wins an innocent victim's trust by imitating a buyer, seller, or service provider. Afterward, a cybercriminal sends a fake payment notification to an innocent victim in the form of a payment link or a screenshot of a "successful payment." In most cases, a victim is asked to approve a payment request on a UPI platform or scan a QR code sent by a cybercriminal. After receiving a false payment notification, an innocent victim trusts the payment and proceeds to approve it. Later on, a cybercriminal withdraws money from an innocent victim's account and transfers it to multiple accounts to escape arrest.

A real life incident of online payment scam occurred when a tea seller from Bhopal lost ₹1.02 lakh due to a fraudulent call that resulted in unauthorized UPI transactions from his account. Once the tea seller discovered this fraudulent transaction, he then reported the incident to the police. (Source: Free Press Journal)

The consequences of online payment fraud include financial loss, mental stress, and erosion of trust in online payment systems. In addition, the victim may face problems in getting back the money they have lost, which is why they need to be aware of the consequences of online payment fraud.